

QUESTION 151

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The cartographer studied the river's seasonal flooding patterns _____ mapped each new channel before the water receded.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: and

B: and,

C: , and

D: , and then she

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: when a single subject ('cartographer') governs two verbs ('studied...and mapped'), no comma goes before 'and.' A comma is only needed when 'and' joins two INDEPENDENT clauses (each with its own subject). D is tempting but adds an unnecessary subject.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 152

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: What the sediment cores reveal about the lake's history _____ more complex than earlier surveys suggested.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: are

B: is

C: were

D: have been

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: a 'what' clause acting as a subject is treated as singular. 'What the sediment cores reveal...is more complex.' Ignore 'cores' (inside the clause). 'Are,' 'were,' and 'have been' are plural.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 153

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The park's nesting program had been declared a success. _____ a winter storm the following year destroyed every artificial platform that rangers had installed.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: However

B: However;

C: However,

D: However:

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'However' at the start of a new sentence is a conjunctive adverb and takes a comma after it. A semicolon or colon after 'However' is wrong punctuation. Omitting the comma makes the sentence run together awkwardly.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 154

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Under the new protocol, if a water sample from the intake pipe _____ coliform levels above the safety threshold, the automated system shuts the valve within seconds.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: showed

B: will show

C: had shown

D: shows

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: real (likely) conditions about present/future use 'if + present tense.' The main clause uses present tense ('shuts'), confirming a habitual/real conditional. 'Shows' is present. 'Showed' and 'had shown' are past. 'Will show' cannot follow 'if' in a conditional.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 155

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: A new chemical tracer developed at the Lundmark Institute helped marine biologists _____ the spawning routes of three endangered fish species across the Gulf.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: identifying

B: identify

C: identified

D: to have identified

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'help/helped + object' takes a bare infinitive (no 'to'): 'helped biologists identify.' 'Identifying' (gerund) and 'identified' (past) do not follow the 'help + object + base verb' pattern. 'To have identified' is a perfect infinitive--wrong here.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 156

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: After decades of failed expeditions, the wreck was finally found in the one place no one had thought to _____ the shallow reef barely a kilometer from shore.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: look--

B: look,

C: look;

D: look:

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: a single dash at the end of a clause introduces a dramatic reveal or restatement. The phrase 'the shallow reef...' restates 'the one place.' A comma (B) lacks the dramatic pause. A semicolon (C) implies two balanced independent clauses. A colon (D) is plausible but the dash better fits the tone of surprise.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 157

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Displayed in the museum's entrance hall, here _____ the original surveyor's compass and the hand-drawn chart that guided the colony's first boundary commission.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: is

B: was

C: has been

D: are

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'here' inverts the subject. The true subject is 'the compass AND the chart' (compound = plural). 'Are' is plural present. 'Is,' 'was,' and 'has been' are all singular.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 158

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: _____ the region's long dry season, the valley's aquifer recharges fully each year thanks to snowmelt seeping through porous limestone.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: Despite that

B: Although

C: Despite

D: Despite of

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'despite' is a preposition and takes a NOUN PHRASE directly: 'Despite the region's long dry season.' 'Although' needs a full clause (subject + verb). 'Despite that' adds an unnecessary pronoun. 'Despite of' is not standard English.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 159

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The review panel must decide whether to fund the study for another three years or _____ and redirect the remaining grant money to newer proposals.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: termination of the project

B: it should be terminated

C: to terminate the project

D: terminating it

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'whether to fund...or to terminate' requires parallel infinitives. The 'to' can carry over ('whether to fund...or terminate') or repeat ('or to terminate'). Only C provides a parallel infinitive. A is a noun phrase, B is a clause, D is a gerund--all break the parallel structure.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 160

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: All of the geochemical evidence collected from the three deepest core samples _____ that the eruption occurred at least two centuries earlier than previously believed.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: have suggested

B: are suggesting

C: suggest

D: suggests

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'all of the [uncountable noun]' takes a singular verb. 'Evidence' is uncountable, so 'suggests' is correct. 'Suggest' is plural. 'Have suggested' and 'are suggesting' are plural forms. 'All of' + uncountable = singular; 'all of' + countable plural = plural.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 161

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The expedition's leader found that navigating the canyon by raft was more dangerous than _____ the ridge on foot, a reversal of what earlier surveys had predicted.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: crossing

B: to cross

C: if they crossed

D: they crossed

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'more dangerous than _____' must parallel the structure before 'than.' 'Navigating...by raft' is a gerund phrase, so the comparison needs a gerund: 'crossing...on foot.' 'To cross' (infinitive), 'if they crossed' (clause), and 'they crossed' (clause) break the parallel structure.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 162

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Although it can seem counterintuitive, behavioral economics _____ increasingly cited as a lens for understanding not just market decisions but also public health choices.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: have been

B: is

C: are

D: were

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'economics' looks plural because of its -s ending, but as a field of study it is singular: 'economics is.' The same applies to 'politics,' 'physics,' and 'news.' 'Have been,' 'are,' and 'were' are plural forms.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 163

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The archive houses ephemera from several defunct transportation companies, such _____ timetables, route maps, and promotional postcards dating to the early 1900s.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: as;

B: as:

C: as,

D: as

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'such as' introduces examples mid-sentence and needs NO punctuation after it. A colon (B) is only used after a complete independent clause--'such as' is not a clause boundary. A semicolon (A) and comma (C) also incorrectly interrupt the phrase.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 164

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: _____ the tidal bore reversed the river's current for nearly thirty minutes, stranding several fishing boats on newly exposed sandbars downstream.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: Because; at high tide,

B: Because, at high tide

C: Because, at high tide,

D: Because at high tide;

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Because at high tide the tidal bore reversed...' is a single subordinate clause. 'At high tide' is a parenthetical within it, set off by commas. A semicolon (A, D) cannot appear inside or after a subordinate clause headed by 'because.' Only C correctly places commas around the parenthetical.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 165

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The new irrigation system benefits the district both by reducing water loss through evaporation and by _____ to fields that older canals could not reach.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: it extends service

B: extending service

C: the extension of service

D: service is extended

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'both by reducing...and by _____' requires parallel gerund phrases.

'Extending service' matches 'reducing water loss.' A clause (A, D) or a noun phrase (C) breaks the 'both by X-ing and by Y-ing' pattern.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 166

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The restorers uncovered a _____ mosaic beneath three centimeters of calcium deposits on the chapel floor.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: vivid, geometric

B: vivid geometric,

C: vivid geometric

D: vivid, geometric,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'vivid' and 'geometric' are coordinate adjectives--each independently modifies 'mosaic.' Coordinate adjectives are separated by a comma: 'vivid, geometric mosaic.' No comma after the second adjective (D is wrong). B and C either misplace or omit the comma.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 167

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Collecting viable seed samples from high-altitude wildflowers _____ specialized drying equipment that most field stations do not carry.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: requires

B: require

C: are requiring

D: have required

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: a gerund phrase as subject ('Collecting...wildflowers') is always singular. 'Requires' is singular present. 'Require,' 'are requiring,' and 'have required' are plural. Do not let 'samples' or 'wildflowers' mislead you--they are inside the phrase.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 168

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Despite three rounds of revisions, the _____ final verdict was to delay publication until the data tables could be independently verified.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: editor's in chief
- B: editor in chief's
- C: editors in chief's
- D: editor in chiefs'

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: for compound nouns like 'editor in chief,' the possessive marker goes on the LAST word: 'editor in chief's.' Placing the apostrophe on 'editor's' (A) treats only the first word as possessive. C implies plural editors. D misspells the plural.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 169

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: If the current pace holds, the conservation team _____ the reforestation of all twelve designated hillsides by the end of next year.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: completed

B: has completed

C: will have completed

D: completes

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'by the end of next year' signals a future deadline for a completed action--future perfect tense. 'Will have completed' marks an action finished before a future point. 'Completed' (past), 'has completed' (present perfect), and 'completes' (present) do not match the future deadline.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 170

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: After the collapse of two retaining walls in a single month, the safety commission insisted that the contractor _____ every remaining wall in the district before any new construction permits could be issued.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: inspects

B: will inspect

C: had inspected

D: inspect

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'insisted that X [verb]' triggers the subjunctive--always the base form, regardless of subject. 'Inspect' is correct, not 'inspects' (indicative). 'Will inspect' and 'had inspected' are wrong mood/tense. The same rule applies to 'demand,' 'require,' and 'recommend.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 171

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The soil survey _____ by a team from the Harland Institute in 2018 remains the most comprehensive assessment of the region's erosion patterns.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: conducting

B: conducted

C: was conducted

D: conducts

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'conducted by a team' is a reduced relative clause (= 'that was conducted by a team'). The past participle alone does this job. 'Was conducted' creates two main verbs ('was conducted...remains') with no conjunction. 'Conducting' implies the survey did the conducting. 'Conducts' is finite present.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 172

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Carved from a single block of jade and _____ to the temple by merchant Liu Baihe in 1403, the statue is now the oldest artifact in the prefecture's collection.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: donated

B: donating

C: it was donated

D: which was donated

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Carved from...and donated to...' forms a pair of parallel past participles modifying 'the statue.' 'Donated' matches 'carved.' 'Donating' (present participle) breaks the parallel. 'It was donated' and 'which was donated' would create a clause that conflicts with the participial opener.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 173

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: According to both researchers, the dispute between _____ arose not from conflicting data but from incompatible statistical models applied to the same data set.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: she and I

B: she and me

C: her and I

D: her and me

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: after a preposition ('between'), all pronouns must be in objective case: 'between her and me.' Test each pronoun alone: 'between her' (correct), 'between me' (correct). 'She' and 'I' are nominative (subject) forms--wrong after a preposition.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 174

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Although the discovery is often attributed to the entire expedition, it was the team's junior geologist, Marisol Fuentes, _____ first recognized the significance of the mineral vein exposed by the landslide.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: whom

B: which

C: who

D: whose

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: in 'it was X who _____' cleft constructions, the relative pronoun refers to a PERSON and serves as the SUBJECT of the following verb ('recognized'). 'Who' is the subject form for people. 'Whom' is object case. 'Which' is for things. 'Whose' is possessive.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 175

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The divers recovered a bronze gear mechanism _____ to an unknown device that scholars believe may have been an early navigational calculator.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: it belonged

B: which it belonged

C: belonging

D: and belonging

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'belonging to an unknown device' is a present-participial phrase modifying 'mechanism.' It attaches directly, no comma needed for a restrictive modifier. 'It belonged' (A) creates a run-on/splice. 'Which it belonged' (B) has a redundant 'it.' 'And belonging' (D) illogically coordinates the participle with 'recovered.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 176

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Biostatistician Anya Kovar _____ all seventeen data sets twice before she submitted the paper that would eventually reshape the field's understanding of antibiotic resistance.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: analyzes

B: has analyzed

C: is analyzing

D: had analyzed

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'before she submitted' (simple past) establishes a reference point in the past. The action that happened FIRST ('analyzing') takes past perfect: 'had analyzed.' 'Has analyzed' is present perfect. 'Analyzes' and 'is analyzing' are present tense.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 177

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Wildflowers of the Northern Cape, a field guide first published in 1982, _____ since been translated into five languages and remains the standard reference for the region's flora.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: has

B: have

C: are

D: were

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: a title of a work ('Wildflowers of the Northern Cape') is always treated as singular, even if the title contains a plural noun. 'Has' is singular. 'Have,' 'are,' and 'were' are plural.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 178

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The instrument measures turbidity, _____ the cloudiness of water caused by suspended particles, and compares each reading against a baseline taken at dawn.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: or:

B: or

C: or;

D: or,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'or' introduces a defining appositive (an alternate name for turbidity). It needs no additional punctuation after it: 'turbidity, or the cloudiness of water...' A colon (A), semicolon (C), or extra comma (D) after 'or' incorrectly breaks the defining phrase.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 179

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: None of the seventeen ice-core samples extracted from the glacier's deepest layer _____ any trace of volcanic ash, contradicting the hypothesis that the eruption had blanketed the entire ice field.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: has contained

B: is containing

C: contains

D: contained

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'none of the [plural noun]' can take either a singular or plural verb, but when the context clearly refers to multiple individual items ('seventeen...samples'), the plural (or contextually past) verb is preferred. 'Contained' (past, matching the past narrative) fits. 'Has contained' and 'contains' are singular present. 'Is containing' is singular progressive.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 180

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: After studying the feasibility reports for nearly a year, the transit authority seriously considered _____ the entire light-rail line and replacing it with a network of electric bus routes.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: to abandon
- B: they would abandon
- C: abandoning
- D: abandon

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'considered' takes a gerund, not an infinitive: 'considered abandoning.' 'To abandon' (infinitive) does not follow 'considered' in standard English. 'They would abandon' (B) introduces a new clause incorrectly. 'Abandon' (D) is a bare infinitive--wrong after 'considered.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 181

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: In the narrow corridor between the mill's loading dock and the river _____ workers once stacked barrels of flour three rows high before each barge arrived.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: bank,

B: bank;

C: bank:

D: bank

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'In the narrow corridor between...the river bank' is a long introductory prepositional phrase. A comma separates it from the main clause. A semicolon (B) implies two independent clauses. A colon (C) implies elaboration. No punctuation (D) makes the sentence hard to parse.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 182

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Laboratory tests confirmed that the bio-adhesive derived from mussel proteins was _____ the leading synthetic alternative, yet it biodegraded completely within eighteen months.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: so strong as

B: as strong as

C: stronger as

D: as strong than

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: the correct comparative idiom for equivalence is 'as [adjective] as.' 'As strong as' is correct. 'Stronger as' mixes comparative + wrong preposition. 'As strong than' mixes the 'as...as' pattern with 'than.' 'So strong as' is archaic/nonstandard in positive statements.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 183

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Prior to _____ the samples to the central laboratory, field technicians must seal each container with a tamper-evident strip and record the ambient temperature at the collection site.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: shipping

B: ship

C: they ship

D: having been shipped

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'prior to' is a compound preposition; it takes a gerund (-ing form). 'Prior to shipping' is correct. 'Ship' (base form) and 'they ship' (clause) cannot follow a preposition. 'Having been shipped' implies the samples were already shipped--wrong, since the sentence describes steps BEFORE shipping.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 184

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The architect drafted the plans in February, the contractor broke ground in April, and the first tenants _____ by December of the same year.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: will move in

B: moved in

C: are moving in

D: move in

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: the narrative is in past tense ('drafted,' 'broke ground'). The final item must maintain tense consistency: 'moved in.' 'Will move in' (future), 'are moving in' (present progressive), and 'move in' (present) break the past-tense pattern.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 185

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The river's eastern tributaries deposited far more silt per season than _____ a disparity that gradually shifted the delta's center of gravity westward.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: the western ones deposited,
- B: were deposited by the western ones,
- C: the western ones,
- D: did the western ones,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: in elliptical comparisons, the second element must grammatically parallel the first. 'More silt than did the western ones' uses 'did' as a pro-verb standing for 'deposited.' C ('the western ones') is tempting but makes it ambiguous (more silt than [they deposited] or more silt than [the western ones themselves]?). D is clearest and most formal.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 186

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The policy created a regulatory gap _____ neither federal inspectors nor local officials had clear authority to enforce water-quality standards.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: which

B: that

C: in which

D: where, and

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'a regulatory gap' is an abstract space. The relative pronoun must show 'inside' the gap. 'In which' correctly means 'within that gap.' 'Which' and 'that' alone lack the preposition (you don't 'enforce standards [which]'). 'Where, and' adds a conjunction that doesn't fit. Note: 'where' would also work for abstract spaces, but 'in which' is more precise in formal writing.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 187

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: When the museum's board transferred the painting to the university's gallery, _____ provenance file was lost in transit, leaving a gap in the artwork's documented history.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: their

B: its

C: its'

D: the painting's

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'its' would be ambiguous--does it refer to the museum's, the board's, the painting's, or the gallery's provenance file? When a pronoun could refer to multiple nouns, clarity requires restating the noun. 'The painting's' removes the ambiguity. 'Its'' is not a valid form. 'Their' is plural.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 188

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Nearly half of the manuscript collection housed in the monastery's lower vault _____ damaged beyond legibility by the flood that breached the cellar wall in 1743.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: have been

B: are

C: was

D: were

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'half of the [noun]' takes its number from the noun. 'Collection' is singular (one collection). So 'was' is correct. If it were 'half of the manuscripts,' the verb would be plural. 'Have been,' 'are,' and 'were' are plural forms.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 189

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The archaeologists did not abandon the excavation because the funding ran _____ they left because monsoon flooding made the trenches unsafe.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: out,

B: out;

C: out:

D: out.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: two independent clauses ('The archaeologists did not abandon...' and 'they left because...') need a semicolon. The sentence clarifies that lack of funding was NOT the reason--flooding was. A comma (A) creates a splice. A colon (C) doesn't fit the contrast. A period (D) works but the semicolon better shows the connection.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 190

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Although the script is centuries old, the calligraphy on the monastery's foundation charter remains remarkably easy _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: to read.

B: reading.

C: for reading.

D: read.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'easy to read' is a standard adjective + infinitive construction. 'Reading' and 'for reading' do not follow 'easy' in standard English. 'Read' (bare infinitive without 'to') is incomplete after 'easy.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 191

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The laboratory's contamination protocols fully activated and _____ doors sealed with magnetic locks, the clean room was ready for the first batch of semiconductor wafers.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: its, all

B: its all

C: all its

D: its; all

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: this is a nominative absolute ('protocols fully activated and all its doors sealed...'). The possessive 'its' modifies 'doors,' and 'all' precedes it as a determiner: 'all its doors.' No comma between 'its' and 'all' (A) or semicolon (D) is needed. B ('its all') puts the words in wrong order.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 192

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The geologist's report ended with a single recommendation: the three fault lines running beneath the stadium _____ continuous monitoring before any renovation work could proceed.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: requires

B: has required

C: is requiring

D: require

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: after the colon, the verb agrees with 'the three fault lines' (plural), not 'recommendation' (singular) from before the colon. 'Require' is plural present. 'Requires,' 'has required,' and 'is requiring' are all singular.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 193

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The restoration project aimed to preserve not only the theater's original facade but also _____ which had been covered by dropped ceilings during a 1970s renovation.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: its ornamental plasterwork,
- B: to preserve its ornamental plasterwork,
- C: preserving its ornamental plasterwork,
- D: that its ornamental plasterwork was preserved,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'not only [noun phrase] but also [noun phrase].' 'The theater's original facade' is a noun phrase, so the parallel element must also be a noun phrase: 'its ornamental plasterwork.' B repeats 'to preserve' (redundant). C switches to a gerund. D uses a clause.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 194

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The team established a field camp near the river's headwaters, _____ the altitude and thin air made even routine tasks exhausting.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: which

B: where

C: in where

D: that

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'the headwaters' is a physical place. 'Where' is the relative adverb for locations: 'near the headwaters, where...' 'Which' needs a preposition ('at which'). 'In where' is not standard. 'That' introduces a restrictive clause but cannot replace 'where' for locations.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 195

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Although the pilot program enrolled only forty students in its first _____ its graduation rate exceeded that of the district's largest high school by twelve percentage points.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: year

B: year,

C: year;

D: year.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Although...its first year' is a subordinate clause that must be followed by a comma before the main clause. A semicolon (C) wrongly treats the 'Although' clause as independent. A period (D) creates a fragment. No punctuation (A) runs the clauses together.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 196

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The glacier retreated more than 200 meters in a single summer, _____ prompted the monitoring team to double the frequency of its satellite surveys.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: which

B: that

C: and it

D: this

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'which' after a comma can refer to the entire preceding clause ('the glacier retreated 200 meters'). 'That' cannot begin a nonessential clause. 'And it' is grammatically possible but less precise--'which' more clearly signals that the whole event was the trigger. 'This' would create a splice.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 197

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: In the center of the excavated floor, there _____ a single unbroken amphora and, surrounding it in concentric rings, dozens of ceramic fragments from vessels that had shattered in the fire.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: were

B: have been

C: are

D: was

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: with 'there' + compound subjects, the verb traditionally agrees with the FIRST item in formal writing. 'A single unbroken amphora' (singular) comes first: 'there was.' Past tense matches the archaeological narrative. 'Were' wrongly agrees with 'dozens.' 'Have been' and 'are' are present tense.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 198

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Before submitting the manuscript, the lead researcher had an independent statistician _____ every regression model to ensure that no computational errors had been introduced.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: to verify

B: verified

C: verify

D: verifying

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'had [someone] [verb]' is a causative construction that takes a bare infinitive: 'had a statistician verify.' 'Verified' (B) would make it past tense narrative, not causative. 'To verify' (A) follows 'asked' or 'hired,' not 'had.' 'Verifying' (D) is a gerund, wrong in this pattern.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 199

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: According to the post-election survey, the majority of voters in the rural parishes _____ dissatisfied with the lack of broadband infrastructure, a finding that surprised the incumbent's campaign staff.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: were

B: was

C: is

D: has been

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'the majority of [plural noun]' takes a plural verb. 'Voters' is plural, so 'were' is correct. 'Was,' 'is,' and 'has been' are singular. If it were 'the majority of the electorate' (singular), the verb would be singular.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 200

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The Danube sturgeon, a species _____ recovery depends on the removal of dams that block its spawning migration, was listed as critically endangered in 2010.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: who's

B: whose

C: which

D: that its

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: the relative pronoun must show possession--'the species' recovery.' 'Whose' is the possessive relative pronoun (usable for both people and things in modern English). 'Who's' = 'who is.' 'Which' lacks possession. 'That its' creates a double subject ('that its recovery depends').

END QUESTION